

OSC Travel & Events - OSS 2026 Minneapolis

Summary

Open Source Summit 2026 reinforced the growing importance of open collaboration, sustainable funding models, and responsible technological innovation across the global open source ecosystem. Representing the Open Source Office alongside members of the Open Source Committee (OSC), the delegation participated in a broad range of technical and strategic discussions that directly align with Cardano's evolving open source strategy and long-term ecosystem goals.

Across the week, artificial intelligence emerged as one of the dominant themes of the conference. Discussions surrounding AI infrastructure, governance, licensing, model transparency, and sustainable computing highlighted the increasing pressure placed on open source communities to balance innovation with accountability. These conversations strongly resonated with ongoing work within the Cardano ecosystem, particularly around transparent governance, sustainability, and the need to preserve community ownership within rapidly evolving technology sectors.

Some attendees also contributed directly to these discussions through a presentation focused on responsible and sustainable funding for open source ecosystems. The session emphasized that long-term ecosystem health cannot rely solely on volunteer labor or fragmented sponsorship models, but instead requires structured stewardship, clear accountability, and recurring investment into maintainers, tooling, security, and developer enablement. The strong engagement and positive feedback from attendees validated the growing industry recognition that open source sustainability is now a strategic necessity rather than a secondary concern.

In addition, the presentation highlighting Reeve demonstrated how operational tooling and ecosystem support services can help bridge the gap between open source infrastructure and enterprise readiness. The session sparked meaningful conversations around scalability, developer experience, operational resilience, and how ecosystem-focused tooling can reduce barriers to adoption for both contributors and organizations.

Beyond formal sessions, the Open Source Summit provided substantial value through networking, relationship building, and direct exposure to how leading open source foundations and enterprises structure their programs, governance models, and funding strategies. Attendees consistently expressed that the event exceeded expectations in both technical depth and organizational quality. Many participants returned with a stronger understanding of the challenges facing large-scale open source ecosystems and a renewed appreciation for the strategic direction currently being developed and managed through the OSC and Open Source Office initiatives.

Guest: Harsha Gullapalli

1. What was the most valuable connection/conversation you had at the summit, how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

One of the most valuable conversations I had was with a computer science student from South Africa who did not really know what blockchain was.

We ended up talking about many things, including his career path, what blockchain actually is, where it can be useful, and how someone with a technical background could start exploring opportunities in this space.

What made the conversation valuable was that it was not just about explaining Cardano or Intersect. It was about helping someone understand that there is a real contribution path available to them. I was able to introduce him to the kind of open-source contribution opportunities being pioneered by Intersect, and the hope is that he eventually shows up, starts contributing, and begins climbing that contribution ladder.

It also changed how I think about communicating with developers. I initially assumed that with technical people, it would be okay to jump into blockchain jargon fairly quickly. But that was not true. Even highly technical people may still be very new to blockchain concepts. So I think we are still very early, and we have to be careful about how we introduce Cardano, Intersect, and open-source participation to people who are technical but new to the ecosystem.

2. What was the general sentiment/reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives and were there any surprises?

The overall reaction was mixed. I met people who were curious, skeptical, confused, excited, and also some people who were just not interested. One thing I noticed is that it was hard to introduce Intersect directly if the person did not even understand what blockchain was. For many people, Intersect was too far down the path if they did not first understand the basics of blockchain, why it matters, and where it can be useful.

Most people I spoke to did not really know about Cardano. In many cases, they did not know much about blockchain beyond just hearing the term. That surprised me, especially because this was an open-source audience. I expected the technical side of blockchain to be more familiar to them, but it was still new even to many technical people.

Some people asked really good questions. For example, one person from the insurance industry was very interested in how blockchain could be used in his field. Others asked about governance, price, consensus, and how Cardano works, especially the few who had already heard about Cardano before.

The pattern I noticed was that people responded much better when we first showed interest in what they cared about. If we listened first, understood their background or interests, and then explained Cardano or Intersect in a way that related to them, the conversation was much stronger. In some cases, people even came back to the booth the next day with more questions.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

One clear recommendation is that before attending summits like this, we should have a small practice session on how to present Cardano, Intersect, and open-source contribution opportunities to different kinds of people.

We should be ready to explain the same idea in different ways depending on whether someone is a complete beginner, someone with some blockchain understanding, or an expert. I do not think the issue is that the contribution path itself is missing. The issue is that we need a better way to present that path based on the person we are speaking to.

Another important follow-up is that we should collect contact information from interested people and reach back out after the event. A lot of good conversations can disappear if there is no follow-up. People need a clear next step.

The follow-up should also not be the same for everyone. Some people want to use the technology, some want to build with it, some want to contribute to open source, and some are just curious. So there should be a simple pipeline for categorizing people based on their interest and then guiding them into the right path inside the Cardano ecosystem and specifically Intersect.

In short, I think the best approach is: listen first, understand the person, explain based on where they are, collect contact information when there is interest, and then follow up with a clear path for how they can participate.

Guest: Jordan Hill

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

I had the opportunity to engage with individuals who were new to blockchain and cryptocurrency while also reconnecting with fellow OSC and Intersect members. These conversations led to discussions around potential future collaborations and highlighted the importance of community-driven initiatives in expanding the Cardano ecosystem.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

The overall sentiment was positive. Many attendees expressed genuine interest in Cardano, Intersect, and related open-source initiatives, along with a willingness to learn more about the ecosystem. One notable observation was that while interest was strong, awareness of these initiatives was often limited, indicating significant room for broader outreach and education.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

A key takeaway was the need for increased investment in marketing, outreach, and community engagement efforts. Compared to other blockchain ecosystems, Cardano and Intersect remain relatively unknown within many open-source circles. Greater visibility at industry events, open-source conferences, and developer communities could help attract new contributors, partnerships, and ecosystem growth.

Guest: James Dunseith

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

My most valuable conversations were with people in the education and dev spaces. I connected with professor Heidi Ellis from Western New England University (WNEU), who had insights about how college students are navigating the quickly changing job market in tech. She validated that blockchain doesn't really have a value prop right now among university students, but also that "trust" is in high demand and short supply. We have a scheduled follow-up in August, and I'm looking forward to building a relationship with the university as a blueprint for more engagements with young people who are defining their career paths and thinking about the problems they really want to solve. Because WNEU is located less than an hour from where I live, there might be a chance for Andamio to offer an internship or two to students. Also, speaking to LFDT about how they approach learning, network and community-building was insightful. And I met a 12 year old kid named Raj who has since joined the Andamio community and is working on some interesting ideas for allowing key holders to share access to documents.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

My biggest surprise is that I truly thought that if you were a developer in 2026, you'd at least have heard about blockchain and thought about what blockchain might be capable of. In so many conversations, people really hadn't thought much about blockchain at all, and most had not heard of Cardano. As we acknowledged at the event, "AI" was really the star of the show. (In the blockchain space, we've all witnessed how quickly AI overtook blockchain as the cutting edge of tech in the early 2020's). But I also found that this opens a door for us. Everyone I spoke to agreed that somehow "trust" is now in shorter supply with AI stacks overtaking everything. When I led with value props around building trust, verification and validation, people really wanted to listen. This value prop leads to the conversation about how "crypto" and "blockchain" are not the same thing, and people were willing to go deep talking about the future, real, role blockchain can play in the tech space.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

My biggest follow-up insight is that (a) we must continue attending this event and other non-blockchain events like it, and (b) we must be more prepared next time. We need hands-on demos for people to experience. We need to talk less and ask more questions. We need to bring people into the "why Cardano" story by listening first and then connecting with what people really need. We don't yet have the "aha!" value prop required for onboarding new builders who will bring new ideas, opportunities, and use cases, and I want Intersect to support the development of these value props so that we can all test messaging out in the field, bring back our insights, and keep refining what works, together.

Guest: Udai Solanki

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

Conversations spanned developers, maintainers, OSS founders, Linux Foundation leadership, and Cardano community members — covering supply chain security, AI, cloud-native development, identity, and governance, not just blockchain. These confirmed Cardano's research-driven development, formal methods, and decentralized governance resonate with experienced engineers. Opportunity: position Cardano as practical enterprise/public-sector infrastructure, not just a blockchain platform. Also strengthened existing Cardano relationships and opened new leads for Intersect.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

Positive once conversations moved past "cryptocurrency." Most attendees knew little about Cardano's governance model or open development process, but interest grew fast once explained. Developers care about practical value — tooling, APIs, docs, production-ready integrations — not ideology. Strong cross-interest in AI, cloud, cybersecurity, identity, and dev tooling shows room for Cardano to engage beyond blockchain-only events. Intersect's presence built credibility with enterprise architects and CTOs.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

Build a long-term OSS engagement strategy instead of treating conferences as one-off events — anchored by a portfolio of production-ready Cardano solutions (SDKs, APIs, identity, governance tools) that can be demoed to prospects, backed by strategic ties to the Linux Foundation and a structured process to nurture contacts into pilots or partnerships

Guest: Samuel Leathers

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

I spoke with a woman from Africa who works with schools to make sure students receiving funding assistance are actually getting those benefits and that the money isn't being redirected somewhere else before it reaches them. That's a problem Cardano was built for. Transparent, verifiable fund distribution where you can actually check on-chain that the money went where it was supposed to go. What struck me was that she had no idea this technology existed. There are people out there with real problems that we've already solved and they just haven't found us yet.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

Honestly most people weren't thinking about Cardano or blockchain at all. They were focused on their own projects and problems. But walking around and talking to people I kept noticing they were struggling with the same things we've been working on in blockchain for years: trust, data integrity, open governance. Nobody came in hostile. They just didn't know much about it. The surprise for me was realizing how much we actually have to offer this community if we show up and have those conversations.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

We need to get out of our blockchain bubble. If we only go to blockchain conferences we're just talking to ourselves. The open source world has problems we've solved and they need to hear from us. We need to make events like this a regular part of our outreach, not a one time thing.

Guest: James Meidinger

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

The most valuable connection was the relationship between OSC/Developer/Builder working in Cardano, both from a business and personal perspective. The second most valuable piece was the interaction with developers in the open source community and more importantly those entering for the first time and asking questions about both what we do on Cardano and specifically to what I do and how that applies.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

The overall sentiment was positive and I was surprised that quite few people I talked too had no experience in crypto or blockchain tech, there were a few that had dabbled but nothing serious either as a user or a developer in a specific chain

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

There is a wealth of new talent that isn't crypto or number go up centric, that means there are fresh ideas that are not tied to or have some sort of inherent bias as to which is the "right" chain or who has the "best" tech. Instead they were interested in learning how the underlying blockchain tech could effectively change the way they operate both privately and professionally.

Guest Marco Russo, Cardano Foundation:

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

I think the most valuable conversation was with a couple of teachers from an L.A. university. They were in the Summit for curiosity and to be updated with the latest tech and ideas and they approached the booth to ask who we were, after talking with them they showed interest in our academy.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

When I spoke with a few people I got to understand that they didn't know about us or distributed layers and blockchain. And after showing them different tool from the community they get interested in how they can use our technologies on their projects.

A few of them already heard once the name of blockchain in the news so it is directly related to crypto currencies. They didn't know all the potential of blockchain besides just cryptos.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

More clear messages printed, more visualisation of products.
No one knows us, let's help them to read from a distance what we can do so they will feel curious to approach and ask.

Guest Sebastian Pabon, OSC : [LinkedIn Post](#)

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

The most valuable connection was with the broader developer community attending the summit itself. Engaging directly in real developer environments is one of the most effective ways to gather honest feedback, about their concerns, ideas, projects, and perspectives on open source and development in general. That kind of exchange is a direct and meaningful contribution to the onboarding and engagement efforts being led by Intersect's Open Source Committee and Cardano's developer communities. You cannot replicate that signal from behind a desk.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

The general reaction was one of genuine curiosity. Most developers hadn't heard much about the technology stack behind blockchain, but once the conversation started, they quickly recognized familiar challenges: sustainable funding, contributor onboarding, long-term maintenance, security governance. These are the same problems they face every day in web2. Notably, this audience tends to be insulated from the noise that dominates social media and crypto spaces, which makes them harder to reach but far more receptive once the discussion is grounded in real engineering and governance realities.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

Attending non-blockchain tech events holds real strategic value. Places like the Linux Foundation Open Source Summit bring together web2 developers, industry leaders, and real-world adopters: communities we genuinely want to connect with.

The recommendation: make this a regular practice. Variety of demos and presentations, booth presence, and materials to share would go a long way. There is an open and receptive audience out there, we just need to meet them where they are.

Guest: Georg Link, PhD.

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

The most valuable connection was with other committee members and Cardano community members. As an outgoing committee member, it was good to have conversation with the next generation of committee members and pass on experiences.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

The broader open source community was curious and interested in Cardano. Many people were introduced to our blockchain for the first time.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

We need to do more branding and marketing, including meeting people in person at events.

Guest Ian McCullough:

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

My most valuable conversation was with Eivind Heiberg, Norway's Honorary Consul General for Minnesota, who is also a personal friend of the Linux Foundation's executive director. That connection put Cardano and Intersect in front of someone with real institutional reach and a line into established open-source leadership. It reinforced my biggest takeaway from the week: our strongest pitch isn't "blockchain," it's that we're building durable open-source infrastructure with serious governance behind it.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

Mixed, but encouraging. Several people came in skeptical of crypto but were pleasantly surprised once we got past the label and into the open-source underpinnings: transparency, public tooling, governance, community ownership. Most understood blockchain's general value but had limited technical depth. The surprise was the other extreme: some genuinely expert attendees, including one strong conversation about BitVMX, the RISC-V protocol behind the Bitcoin-to-Cardano bridge.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

Lead with the open-source and governance story. Two concrete actions: first, follow up on the institutional relationships from the summit — the consul connection and, through it, the Linux Foundation orbit — before they go cold. Second, build a tiered explainer set so we can pitch Cardano and Intersect to a beginner, a generalist, or a technical expert depending on who's in front of us. The interest is there once the framing is right; we need a repeatable way to convert it.

Guest: Bora Oben - OSC/CF

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

One conversation was with a software engineer from a financial institution. He mentioned that there are groups inside the organization trying to understand blockchain and evaluate where it fits, but that there is a shortage of internal know-how that can “bridge the gap”, or more concretely come up with practical business applications they can work on.

This pattern has come up multiple times and it reflected many of the conversations I had throughout the summit. The discussion was rarely about Cardano versus another blockchain. Most people were trying to understand what is possible today, what is real versus hype, and what useful things are already being built that they could interact with.

The interpretation is fairly clear here. Educating the masses and addressing the general public aka “growing the pie” is a strategy an ecosystem should pursue alongside competing inside the existing web3 native community. A funnel for organic growth is possible, but that Cardano and blockchain as a whole need to do a better job of enabling interactions where the network itself can fade into the background and act purely as an enabler. This takes time, and it is the path we are currently on.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

What I found interesting was that once the conversation moved away from blockchain itself and toward topics like sustainability, governance, funding open source, maintainer support, and ecosystem coordination, it became much easier to relate. Many attendees realized we are dealing with a lot of the same challenges they face in their own projects. At that point the discussion was less about crypto and more about how different communities organize themselves to sustain technology over the long term.

A lot of attendees had heard about blockchain through media coverage, but had very little exposure to the actual builders, projects, tooling, governance systems, open-source work, and products that exist around it.

People generally understand outcomes and applications better than infrastructure.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

I think the preparation around the expected attendee profile before events like this and having a clear picture of which ecosystem projects, products, services may be relevant to them is driving the strategy.

Many people do not actively look to become developers or a new consumer of an app overnight. We try to understand whether there was something within the ecosystem that could help solve a problem they already had or provide them a value surplus. Being able to more quickly connect those people with existing solutions would create more for both attendees and the ecosystem participants.

Guest: Adam Dean

1. What was the most valuable connection or conversation you had at the summit, and how does it relate to the broader goals of Intersect or the Cardano ecosystem?

I had two really impactful conversations that were not planned or scripted. The first was with a developer working on a new Operating System (OS) during the bus ride between the event and the evening mixer where we happened to be seated next to each other randomly. We introduced ourselves and what we do. The conversation naturally led to discussing how Blockchain could be used for securing the trust of SBOMs and package managers and the root of trust certification. Unfortunately, I did not have a solution "in hand" to demonstrate how this could work in practice to refer him to. I later learned that there was at least a start to attempt to build this for Aiken by Arnaud Bailly, but it's unclear if this is actively being used or maintained or productized. The second was with a person in attendance representing the US Air Force. Again, there was a very rudimentary understanding that "Blockchain = Bitcoin", no real adversity to the concept of the technology but a lack of clarity regarding how Blockchain could actually be meaningfully used within existing systems and processes.

2. What was the general sentiment or reaction from the broader Open Source community when learning about Cardano, Intersect OSC/OSO, or related initiatives — and were there any surprises?

The overall impression I received from the many attendees I spoke to was an overall openness to Blockchain, not so much to crypto (lots of scams and hacks there huh?). We lacked a clear call to action for both Intersect and Cardano. What is the value proposition to a random technology conference attendee to become a member of Intersect? What can they actually do here? Similarly, we have resources for people who are ready to build on Cardano (developer portal, etc) but not a clear product offering map to showcase existing solutions that they can adopt today. Many people present were either selling their own solutions or looking for solutions that were ready to go today. There seemed to be a lack of interest in becoming a new Blockchain developer creating a new product built on Cardano, but that was never really the audience of this conference. When penetrating external industry events we must have clear solutions rather than vague promises we are offering: here is the software/API you can integrate into your existing stack to bring blockchain integration to your existing product. Aiming for developers should be a focus at Blockchain and crypto or specifically developer conferences.

3. What's one concrete follow-up action, opportunity, or recommendation that came out of your attendance — something Intersect or the community should act on?

Be less concerned with trying to onboard new members to Intersect when attending external industry facing events. Identify the likely target audience of the convention and be prepared with a list of solutions that exist and are ready to go so that we can generate qualified leads for the members of intersect who have the products and services ready to go. This drives the value of Intersect membership by companies/individuals who are building solutions on top of Cardano more than a random new member of the MBO who will likely not become actively involved and engaged.

This requires a bit more pre-planning to identify who the likely attendees will be, which industries they will represent, etc. Then we need to walk that user journey from whatever they currently have or are doing and how we can make it easy for them to adopt blockchain by way of Cardano in a few easy steps using these software packages or services.

Conclusion

The summit strengthened internal alignment among attendees. Exposure to mature open source programs and successful sustainability models reinforced confidence in the importance of Cardano's own open source initiatives, including maintainer sustainability, developer advocacy, tooling support, security coordination, and ecosystem-wide collaboration efforts. The experience created stronger conviction that proactive investment in open source operations is essential to ensuring the long-term resilience and competitiveness of the ecosystem.

Open Source Summit should be viewed as a strategic, high-value engagement opportunity and a must-attend event for future years. The combination of technical education, ecosystem collaboration, industry visibility, and strategic alignment offers significant value not only to operational teams, but to the broader Cardano community and its long-term open source ambitions.

Attendees: Terence 'Tex' McCutcheon (Intersect), Georg Link (OSC), Sebastian Pabon (OSC), Udai Solanki (OSC), Jordan Hill (OSC), Bora Oben (Cardano Foundation, OSC), Marco Russo (Cardano Foundation), James Dunseith (Community), Harsha Gullapalli (Community), James Meidinger (Community), Samuel Leathers (IOG), Adam Dean (Community), Ian McCullough (Community)